Where a closer look at DPWH flood control spending may be warranted

Stakeholder brief for audit teams, oversight bodies and researchers · Data: 9,827 completed projects, July 2022 to May 2025

Context

This brief uses public records of 9,827 completed DPWH flood control projects, worth about ₱544 billion in contract value. The question: do the records show patterns that suggest where auditors should look first?

Main finding

There is no nationwide red flag. The leads are local. In most provinces no contractor dominates (the typical top contractor holds about 19% of a province's contract value), but in a few, one contractor holds far more: Marinduque 41%, Bukidnon 39%, Romblon 39% and Abra 39%.

Separately, about 3% of projects cost much more than comparable projects in the same region. These cluster in Region IV-B, especially Oriental Mindoro (14% of its projects), and in Abra (14%). Costs also rose steadily over the period, from an average of ₱33M per contract in mid-2022 to ₱76M in early 2025, so projects must be compared with others from the same year. Without that adjustment, later projects look unusual only because prices rose.

Why it matters

Audit time is limited. These patterns can help decide where to start, and comparing projects within the same region and year avoids flagging later projects simply because costs went up.

Recommended actions

1. **Start document review with the seven provinces where both patterns overlap:** Marinduque, Bukidnon, Romblon, Abra, Sorsogon, Samar and Northern Samar, plus Oriental Mindoro for its high rate of costly projects.
2. **Check flagged projects against DPWH Project DIME and COA reports before drawing any conclusion.** Higher costs can reflect terrain, design or project size that this data does not capture.
3. **Publish standard contractor names, IDs and project size in the open data.** Truncated and inconsistent names make the concentration figures approximate.

Caution

These are statistical indicators for prioritising review, not evidence of wrongdoing. The data covers completed projects only and holds no information on how contracts were awarded. Provinces with fewer than 30 projects were left out of the concentration ranking because their figures are unreliable.

Source: DPWH flood control project data (Kaggle: bwandowando/dpwh-flood-control-projects), cleaned and analysed in the DEP Data Engineering Open Track project. Full method: notebooks/M5_segmentation_kpis_brief.ipynb